

English

Class 1 · Learn & Practise

Chapter 17: More Story Time and Poems

Letters & phonics · grammar · reading · writing · answer keys

CHAPTER 17

More Story Time and Poems

🎯 **In this chapter I will learn:**

- read more short stories and poems
- answer who, what, where and why questions
- learn new words with pictures
- practise phonics and grammar from each story

All stories and poems here are written for this book, using the themes of the Grade 1 reader units.

📅 Twelve Months, Seven Days

📖 **Twelve Months, Seven Days**

January starts the year, then February comes,
March and April bring the rain, May is full of hums.
June and July, hot and bright, August fills the sky,
September, October, November, then December says goodbye.

Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday too,
Saturday and Sunday – a week is done for you!
Did you know? Every fourth year February gets one extra day. That year is called a ***leap year****.*

	Word	Meaning
📅	**month**	a part of a year; there are 12
🗓️	**week**	7 days
☀️	**day**	24 hours
🐸	**leap**	to jump
🎂	**birthday**	the day you were born
🔁	**year**	12 months

Exercise 17.1: Twelve Months, Seven Days: questions

Say and write.

1. How many months are in a year?
2. Which month starts the year?
3. Which month comes before March?
4. How many days are in a week?
5. Which two days are the weekend (in this poem)?

Exercise 17.2: Twelve Months, Seven Days: Months and days

Fill in.

1. The last month is _____.
2. The day after Friday is _____.
3. Name one more month with 31 days: _____
4. Magic e: pin → _____
5. Magic e: bon + e → _____

🐛 The Brown Caterpillar

📖 **The Brown Caterpillar**

Brown and furry, soft and slow,
Caterpillar, where do you go?
Up a leaf and down a stalk,
Munch, munch, munch – it is time to eat and walk.
Birds may peck and frogs may peep,
But in a leaf you hide and sleep.
One bright day you will open wide
With painted wings – a butterfly!

	Word	Meaning
🐛	**caterpillar**	a furry crawling insect
🍃	**leaf**	part of a plant
🦋	**butterfly**	an insect with colourful wings
🐦	**bird**	it has feathers and wings
😴	**sleep**	to rest
🌿	**stalk**	the stem of a plant

Exercise 17.3: The Brown Caterpillar: questions

Say and write.

1. This poem is about a _____.
2. What colour is the caterpillar?
3. What does it eat?
4. What does the caterpillar grow into?
5. Who may peck the caterpillar?

Exercise 17.4: The Brown Caterpillar: Rhyming words

Write the word that rhymes.

1. slow – g_____
2. stalk – w_____
3. peep – s_____
4. wide – h_____
5. eat – m_____

🐄 Hey Diddle Diddle

📖 **Hey Diddle Diddle**

Hey, diddle, diddle,
The cat and the fiddle,
The cow jumped over the moon;
The little dog laughed to see such sport,
And the dish ran away with the spoon.
(A well-loved old rhyme. Say it with actions!)

	Word	Meaning
🐱	**cat**	a pet that purrs
🎻	**fiddle**	a small violin
🐄	**cow**	gives milk
🌙	**moon**	shines at night
🍽️	**dish**	a plate or bowl
🥄	**spoon**	used to eat soup

Exercise 17.5: Hey Diddle Diddle: questions

Say and write.

1. Who played the fiddle?
2. What did the cow jump over?
3. Who laughed?
4. What ran away with the spoon?

Exercise 17.6: Hey Diddle Diddle: Naming words and -oon words

Answer.

1. Underline one animal in the rhyme: cat, cow or _____
2. A thing in the rhyme: _____
3. -oon words: m_____n, sp_____n, n_____n
4. Put in order: moon the cow over jumped the

🤒 Mr Phil Feels Ill

📖 **Mr Phil Feels Ill**

Mr Phil felt ill. His head was hot and his body was full of chills. Dr Small came with a bag. "Did you eat at the stall by the mall?" asked Dr Small. "Yes, a pie," said Mr Phil. "Take this pill, drink a full jug of water and rest in bed," said the doctor. In two days Mr Phil was well. He did not eat street food again!

	Word	Meaning
🤒	**ill**	not well
💊	**pill**	a small medicine tablet
👨‍⚕️	**doctor**	helps sick people
🛏️	**bed**	where we sleep
💧	**water**	we drink it
🏬	**mall**	a big shopping place

Exercise 17.7: Mr Phil Feels Ill: questions

Say and write.

1. Who felt ill?
2. Who came to see him?
3. What did he eat?
4. What did the doctor tell him to take?
5. Was he well in two days?

Exercise 17.8: Mr Phil Feels Ill: The -ill, -all and -ull words

Fill with ill / all / ull.

1. p_____ (medicine)
2. m_____ (shopping place)
3. f_____ (not empty)
4. t_____ (not short)
5. h_____ (a small mountain)

🐊 Uncle Munu's Odd Pets

📖 **Uncle Munu's Odd Pets**

Most people keep a dog or a cat. Uncle Munu keeps odd pets! In his big pond lives a green crocodile who eats fish. Four slow tortoises munch lettuce and leaves in his garden. In a glass room he has a tank of harmless snakes. The biggest pet is an elephant who loves bananas. Uncle Munu says one day he will keep a dinosaur. Everyone laughs because they know he is joking.

	Word	Meaning
	**crocodile**	a big green reptile
	**tortoise**	a slow animal with a shell
	**snake**	a long animal with no legs
	**elephant**	biggest land animal
	**fish**	lives in water
	**dinosaur**	an animal that lived long ago

Exercise 17.9: Uncle Munu's Odd Pets: questions

Say and write.

1. Where does the crocodile live?
2. What do the tortoises eat?
3. Which pet loves bananas?
4. Why do people laugh?
5. Which pets are vegetarian?

Exercise 17.10: Uncle Munu's Odd Pets: Describing words

Pick an adjective: big, green, slow, glass.

1. a _____ crocodile
2. _____ tortoises
3. a _____ tank
4. a _____ elephant
5. Land, water or both? tortoise _____

🧸 Rani's Messy Room

📖 **Rani's Messy Room**

Rani's room was in a mess. Clothes were on the bed. Toys were on the floor. A plate lay on the table. Her books were open on the carpet. "Rani, please clean your room," said Mother. Rani put the books on the shelf and the toys in the toy box. She took the plate to the kitchen and folded her clothes. The room looked bright and neat. "Well done!" said Mother with a big smile.

	Word	Meaning
👗	**clothes**	things we wear
🧸	**toys**	things we play with
📚	**shelf**	a place for books
🧺	**fold**	to bend cloth neatly
🧹	**clean**	not dirty
😊	**neat**	tidy

Exercise 17.11: Rani's Messy Room: questions

Say and write.

1. Where were the clothes?
2. Where did Rani put the toys?
3. What did she do with the plate?
4. Why was Mother happy?
5. Is it good to keep your room tidy?

Exercise 17.12: Rani's Messy Room: Use because

Complete the sentence with a reason.

1. Rani cleaned her room _____ Mother asked her to.
2. I wear a raincoat _____ it is raining.

3. Things on the floor can make us _____ (fall / sit)
4. Toys go in the toy _____.
5. Why do we brush our teeth? To keep them _____.

👟 My New Shiny Shoes

📖 **My New Shiny Shoes**

My new shoes are bright and red,
They go clip-clop when I tread.
My old shoes were soft and worn,
They felt like home from dusk to morn.
New shoes squeak and old ones slide,
Which will I wear for my school ride?

	Word	Meaning
👟	**shoes**	we wear them on our feet
🥿	**slippers**	light footwear for home
👡	**sandals**	open shoes for summer
🧢	**cap**	worn on the head
👕	**shirt**	worn on the body
💍	**ring**	worn on a finger

Exercise 17.13: My New Shiny Shoes: questions

Say and write.

1. What colour are the new shoes?
2. What sound do they make?
3. How were the old shoes?
4. Which shoes do you like? Why?

Exercise 17.14: My New Shiny Shoes: Group names

Write the group name: footwear / clothes / jewellery.

1. shoes, sandals, slippers → _____
2. shirt, frock, trousers → _____
3. ring, chain, earrings → _____
4. Add -ple: ap + _____
5. Add -ble: ta + _____

✨ Meena and the Fireflies

📖 **Meena and the Fireflies**

One summer night Meena visited her grandma. It was warm and a gentle breeze was blowing. Outside the window tiny lights danced in the dark. "What are they?" asked Meena. "Fireflies," said Grandma. "They glow so that friends can find each other." Meena caught a few in a jar and watched them shine. Then she opened the lid. One by one the fireflies flew away. "Nature is happiest when she is free," said Grandma.

	Word	Meaning
✨	**firefly**	an insect that glows at night
🫙	**jar**	a glass container
🌙	**night**	when it is dark
🌬️	**breeze**	a gentle wind
👵	**grandma**	your father's or mother's mother
🕊️	**free**	able to go where you like

Exercise 17.15: Meena and the Fireflies: questions

Say and write.

1. Whom did Meena visit?
2. What did she see outside?
3. Where did she keep the fireflies for a while?

4. Why did she let them go?
5. When do fireflies glow?

Exercise 17.16: Meena and the Fireflies: Verbs: fly / flying / flew

Choose the right word.

1. The bird is _____ to its nest. (fly / flying / flew)
2. Birds _____ in the sky. (fly / flying / flew)
3. Yesterday the fireflies _____ away. (fly / flying / flew)
4. They have _____ to see Grandma. (go / going / gone)
5. She is _____ to school. (go / going / gone)

🍕 A Trip to the Food Court

📖 **A Trip to the Food Court**

Aunt Bina took the children to the food court. Each child had some money. Hamida bought a bar of chocolate. Feroz bought a packet of chips. Maria bought a jar of jam. Hari bought a slice of pizza and Charles bought a fresh strawberry tart. At home they put everything on the table and shared. Everyone got to taste a little of each. Sharing is clever and kind!

	Word	Meaning
🍫	**chocolate**	a sweet treat
🍟	**chips**	salty fried potato
🍕	**pizza**	a round baked food with cheese
🍓	**strawberry**	a small red fruit
🍯	**jam**	sweet spread made from fruit
🤝	**share**	to give a part to others

Exercise 17.17: A Trip to the Food Court: questions

Say and write.

1. Who took the children to the food court?
2. What did Hari buy?
3. Who bought something salty?
4. Which food is made from fruit?
5. Why is sharing clever?

Exercise 17.18: A Trip to the Food Court: Healthy or treat?

Write H for healthy, T for treat.

1. apple _____
2. chocolate _____
3. milk _____
4. chips _____
5. carrot _____

🥕 The Vegetable Basket

📖 **The Vegetable Basket**

Bindu Didi brings a big basket of vegetables. There are tomatoes, onions and potatoes. There are green beans and peas, orange carrots and purple brinjals. Broccoli looks like tiny trees. Pumpkins are round and yellow. Bitter gourd is bumpy like a crocodile. Some vegetables can be eaten raw, others must be cooked. Vegetables help us grow big and strong!

	Word	Meaning
	**tomato**	a red round vegetable
	**carrot**	long and orange
	**broccoli**	looks like a tiny tree
	**onion**	makes eyes water
	**potato**	grows under the ground
	**brinjal**	purple vegetable

Exercise 17.19: The Vegetable Basket: questions

Say and write.

1. Who brings the vegetables?
2. Which vegetable looks like tiny trees?
3. What colour are carrots?
4. Which vegetables can be eaten raw?
5. Why should we eat vegetables?

Exercise 17.20: The Vegetable Basket: Naming words, colours

Match the colour.

1. carrot is _____
2. tomato is _____
3. peas are _____
4. brinjal is _____
5. Two vegetables starting with c: _____

🙏 Please and Thank You

📖 Please and Thank You

Eve has a friend named Steve.
She says "please" and "thank you" when she can.
She does not burp, she does not shout,
She says "excuse me" and waits her turn out.
Good manners cost us nothing at all,
But make us dear to one and all.

	Word	Meaning
🙏	**please**	a polite word for asking
😊	**thank you**	we say it when we get something
🤭	**excuse me**	said before you interrupt
⏳	**wait**	to stay until it is your turn
🤝	**friend**	someone you like
📣	**shout**	to speak very loudly

Exercise 17.21: Please and Thank You: questions

Say and write.

1. What are the two friends' names?
2. What polite words does Eve say?
3. What does she say before speaking?
4. Name one good manner.

Exercise 17.22: Please and Thank You: Make new words with -ing

Add -ing.

1. say → _____
2. help → _____
3. wait → _____

4. put → _____

5. get → _____

Silky the Spider and Friends

📖 **Silky the Spider and Friends**

Silky the spider had no friends. The other bugs were afraid of his long thin legs. He lived on a web between two trees. One day Silky had an idea. He made a soft web like a hammock. Then he made a web like a trampoline and one like a swing. The ladybirds, ants and butterflies came to play. "Silky is clever!" they said. They forgot to be afraid. After that Silky always had friends.

	Word	Meaning
	spider	has eight legs
	ladybird	a small red insect with dots
	ant	a very small insect
	butterfly	an insect with colourful wings
	web	a spider's home
	swing	you sit and move to and fro

Exercise 17.23: Silky the Spider and Friends: questions

Say and write.

1. Why did the bugs run from Silky?
2. What did Silky make with his web?
3. Who came to play?
4. What did Silky have in the end?

Exercise 17.24: Silky the Spider and Friends: Insects and legs

Answer.

1. A spider has _____ legs.
2. An insect has _____ legs.
3. Which is not an insect: ant, spider, bee? _____
4. Spider + web → _____
5. Say a describing word for Silky: _____

🐘 Tinu the Forgetful Elephant

📖 **Tinu the Forgetful Elephant**

Tinu was a young elephant who forgot everything. He forgot names. He forgot where he was going. Once he went to fetch bananas and came back with nothing in his trunk! His friend Kiki the crocodile said, "Tie a knot in your tail. When you see it you will remember there is something to do." Tinu tried. He tied a knot, saw it and remembered to bring bananas. His mother was happy. Tinu still forgets names but now he has a trick to remember his work.

	Word	Meaning
🐘	**elephant**	a big animal with a trunk
🐊	**crocodile**	a big reptile
🪢	**knot**	a tied string
🍌	**banana**	a long yellow fruit
🧠	**remember**	to keep in your mind
😶	**forget**	not to remember

Exercise 17.25: Tinu the Forgetful Elephant: questions

Say and write.

1. What was Tinu's problem?
2. Who helped him?
3. What was the trick?

4. Pick the word for Tinu: forgetful, angry or lazy?
5. How can you remember things?

Exercise 17.26: Tinu the Forgetful Elephant: He / she / it / they

Choose the right pronoun.

1. Tinu is an elephant. _____ is big. (He / She)
2. Meera and Rita are friends. _____ play. (We / They)
3. The knot is on the tail. _____ is red. (It / He)
4. Add -ed: help → _____
5. Add -ing: jump → _____

🗣️ I Talk, I Walk

📖 **I Talk, I Walk**

Kittens mew, doves coo, ducks quack, hens cluck,
Lions roar, dogs bark, cows moo, monkeys chatter.

Frogs hop, snakes slither, horses trot, kangaroos jump,
Snails crawl, birds fly, fish swim, but I talk and I walk!

	Word	Meaning
🐱	**mew**	sound of a kitten
🦆	**quack**	sound of a duck
🐸	**hop**	a frog's movement
🐍	**slither**	move like a snake
🐴	**trot**	how a horse walks
🐌	**crawl**	move slowly on the ground

Exercise 17.27: I Talk, I Walk: questions

Say and write.

1. What sound does a duck make?
2. What does a kitten say?
3. How does a frog move?
4. Which animal slithers?
5. What can people do that animals in the poem cannot?

Exercise 17.28: I Talk, I Walk: Doing words (verbs)

Write the sound or action.

1. A cow says _____.
2. A lion _____.
3. A bird _____.
4. A fish _____.
5. A snail _____.

🔑 Answer key – Chapter 17: More Story Time and Poems

Exercise 17.1: Twelve Months, Seven Days: questions

1. 12 • **2.** January • **3.** February • **4.** 7 • **5.** Saturday and Sunday

Exercise 17.2: Twelve Months, Seven Days: Months and days

1. December • **2.** Saturday • **3.** May / July / August / October / December • **4.** pine • **5.** bone

Exercise 17.3: The Brown Caterpillar: questions

1. caterpillar • **2.** Brown • **3.** Leaves • **4.** A butterfly • **5.** Birds

Exercise 17.4: The Brown Caterpillar: Rhyming words

1. go • **2.** walk • **3.** sleep • **4.** hide • **5.** meat / heat / seat

Exercise 17.5: Hey Diddle Diddle: questions

1. The cat • **2.** The moon • **3.** The little dog • **4.** The dish

Exercise 17.6: Hey Diddle Diddle: Naming words and -oon words

1. dog • **2.** fiddle / moon / dish / spoon • **3.** oo • **4.** The cow jumped over the moon.

Exercise 17.7: Mr Phil Feels Ill: questions

1. Mr Phil • **2.** Dr Small • **3.** A pie at a stall • **4.** A pill and plenty of water • **5.** Yes

Exercise 17.8: Mr Phil Feels Ill: The -ill, -all and -ull words

1. ill • **2.** all • **3.** ull • **4.** all • **5.** ill

Exercise 17.9: Uncle Munu's Odd Pets: questions

1. In the pond • **2.** Lettuce and leaves • **3.** The elephant • **4.** Because Uncle Munu is joking. • **5.** The tortoises and the elephant

Exercise 17.10: Uncle Munu's Odd Pets: Describing words

1. green • **2.** slow • **3.** glass • **4.** big • **5.** land

Exercise 17.11: Rani's Messy Room: questions

1. On the bed • **2.** In the toy box • **3.** Took it to the kitchen • **4.** Because the room was clean and neat. • **5.** Yes

Exercise 17.12: Rani's Messy Room: Use because

1. because • **2.** because • **3.** fall • **4.** box • **5.** clean

Exercise 17.13: My New Shiny Shoes: questions

1. Red • **2.** Clip-clop • **3.** Soft and worn • **4.** answers vary

Exercise 17.14: My New Shiny Shoes: Group names

1. footwear • **2.** clothes • **3.** jewellery • **4.** ple (apple) • **5.** ble (table)

Exercise 17.15: Meena and the Fireflies: questions

1. Her grandma • **2.** Tiny dancing lights (fireflies) • **3.** In a jar • **4.** Because they should be free. • **5.** At night

Exercise 17.16: Meena and the Fireflies: Verbs: fly / flying / flew

1. flying • **2.** fly • **3.** flew • **4.** gone • **5.** going

Exercise 17.17: A Trip to the Food Court: questions

1. Aunt Bina • **2.** A slice of pizza • **3.** Feroz (chips) • **4.** Jam / strawberry tart • **5.** Because everyone gets to taste many things.

Exercise 17.18: A Trip to the Food Court: Healthy or treat?

1. H • **2.** T • **3.** H • **4.** T • **5.** H

Exercise 17.19: The Vegetable Basket: questions

1. Bindu Didi • **2.** Broccoli • **3.** Orange • **4.** Carrot, tomato, cucumber (any sensible answer) • **5.** To grow big and strong.

Exercise 17.20: The Vegetable Basket: Naming words, colours

1. orange • **2.** red • **3.** green • **4.** purple • **5.** carrot, cabbage / cucumber / capsicum

Exercise 17.21: Please and Thank You: questions

1. Eve and Steve • **2.** Please and thank you • **3.** Excuse me • **4.** answers vary (waiting for your turn, saying please...)

Exercise 17.22: Please and Thank You: Make new words with -ing

1. saying • **2.** helping • **3.** waiting • **4.** putting • **5.** getting

Exercise 17.23: Silky the Spider and Friends: questions

1. His legs were long and thin and they were afraid. • **2.** A hammock, a trampoline and a swing • **3.** Ladybirds, ants and butterflies • **4.** Friends

Exercise 17.24: Silky the Spider and Friends: Insects and legs

1. 8 • **2.** 6 • **3.** spider • **4.** spider web • **5.** clever / kind / thin

Exercise 17.25: Tinu the Forgetful Elephant: questions

1. He forgot things. • **2.** Kiki the crocodile • **3.** Tie a knot in his tail. • **4.** forgetful • **5.** answers vary (write them down, tie a knot...)

Exercise 17.26: Tinu the Forgetful Elephant: He / she / it / they

1. He • **2.** They • **3.** It • **4.** helped • **5.** jumping

Exercise 17.27: I Talk, I Walk: questions

1. Quack • **2.** Mew • **3.** It hops. • **4.** A snake • **5.** Talk and walk

Exercise 17.28: I Talk, I Walk: Doing words (verbs)

1. moo • **2.** roars • **3.** flies • **4.** swims • **5.** crawls